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A rival manufacturer recently announced similar plans to introduce a mechanical pencil that would accept only the leads produced by that manufacturer.

•

In extensive test marketing, mechanical-pencil users found the new Write Company pencil markedly superior to other mechanical pencils they had used.

•

Enterprise Bank currently requires customers with checking accounts to maintain a minimum balance or pay a monthly fee. Enterprise plans to offer accounts with no monthly fee and no minimum-balance requirement; to cover their projected administrative costs of $3 per account per month, they plan to charge $30 for overdrawing an account. Since each month on average slightly more than 10 percent of Enterprise's customers overdraw their accounts, bank officials predict the new accounts will generate a profit.

Which of the following, if true, most strongly supports the bank officials' prediction?

A. Some of Enterprise Bank's current checking account customers are expected to switch to the new accounts once they are offered.

B. One-third of Enterprise Bank's revenues are currently derived from monthly fees tied to checking accounts.

C. Many checking account customers who occasionally pay a fee for not maintaining a minimum balance in their account generally maintain a balance well above the minimum.

D. Customers whose checking accounts do not have a minimum-balance requirement are more likely than others to overdraw their checking accounts.

E. Customers whose checking accounts do not have a minimum-balance requirement are more likely than others to write checks for small amounts.

•

Highway official: When resurfacing our concrete bridges, we should use electrically conductive concrete (ECC) rather than standard concrete. In the winter, ECC can be heated by passing an electric current through it, thereby preventing ice buildup. The cost of the electricity needed is substantially lower than the cost of the deicing salt we currently use.

Taxpayer: But ECC is vastly more expensive than standard concrete, so your proposal is probably not justifiable on economic grounds.

Which of the following, if true, could best be used by the highway official to support the official's proposal in the face of the taxpayer's objection?

A. The use of deicing salt causes corrosion of reinforcing steel in concrete bridge decks and damage to the concrete itself, thereby considerably shortening the useful life of concrete bridges.

B. Severe icing conditions can cause power outages and slow down the work of emergency crews trying to get power restored.

C. In weather conditions conducive to icing, ice generally forms on the concrete surfaces of bridges well before it forms on parts of the roadway that go over solid ground.

D. Aside from its potential use for deicing bridges, ECC might also be an effective means of keeping other concrete structures such as parking garages and airport runways ice free.

E. If ECC were to be used for a bridge surface, the electric current would be turned on only at times at which ice was likely to form.

•

In virtually any industry, technological improvements increase labor productivity, which is the output of goods and services per person-hour worked. In Parland's industries, labor productivity is significantly higher than it is in Vergia's industries. Clearly, therefore, Parland's industries must, on the whole, be further advanced technologically than Vergia's are. The argument is most vulnerable to which of the following criticisms?

A. It offers a conclusion that is no more than a paraphrase of one of the pieces of information provided in its support.

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B. It presents as evidence in support of a claim information that is inconsistent with other evidence presented in support of the same claim.

C. It takes one possible cause of a condition to be the actual cause of that condition without considering any other possible causes.

D. It takes a condition to be the effect of something that happened only after the condition already existed.

E. It makes a distinction that presupposes the truth of the conclusion that is to be established.

•

Chaco Canyon, a settlement of the ancient Anasazi culture in North America, had massive buildings. **It must have been a major Anasazi center.** Analysis of wood samples shows that some of the timber for the buildings came from the Chuska and San Mateo mountains, 50 miles from Chaco Canyon. **Only a major cultural center would have the organizational power to import timber from 50 miles away.**

In the argument given, the two portions in **boldface** play which of the following roles?

A. The first is a premise used to support the argument's main conclusion; the second is the argument's main conclusion.

B. The first is the argument's main conclusion; the second is a premise used to support that conclusion.

C. The first is one of two premises used to support the argument's main conclusion; the second is the other of those two premises.

D. The first is a premise used to support the argument's main conclusion; the second is a premise used to support another conclusion drawn in the argument.

E. The first is inferred from another statement in the argument; the second is inferred from the first.

•

Paper and plastic grocery bags are a continuing problem for the city, both as litter and in landfills. To discourage their use, the city council has proposed a tax on each bag to be paid by the supermarkets that supply them. Several environmental groups, however, oppose the tax despite having brought the issue to the council's attention in the first place.

Which of the following, if true, would best explain the environmental groups' opposition to the proposed tax?

A. The city's current tax revenue is insufficient to pay the cost of recycling paper and plastic grocery bags.

B. The cost to the city of collecting and disposing of a grocery bag is greater than the proposed tax per bag.

C. Plastic bags account for 90 percent of the grocery bags that litter the city's streets and take up space in landfills.

D. Only supermarkets distributing more than a certain number of grocery bags each month would be subject to the proposed tax.

E. Supermarkets plan to pass the tax on to consumers, who are unlikely to change their behavior based on the small increase in their grocery bills.

•

Regulations will not allow a pesticide that is toxic to humans to be used inside houses unless the pesticide will dissipate completely from the air within eight hours after its application. One test pesticide manufacturers typically use to determine how quickly anti-termite pesticides dissipate involves spraying the pesticides on the walls of room-sized plywood boxes and then timing their dissipation.

Which of the following would it be most useful to know in order to evaluate whether a dissipation time of just under eight hours on the manufacturers' test indicates an anti-termite pesticide that is toxic to humans obeys regulations for use in houses?

A. Whether anti-termite pesticides dissipate more slowly in furnished rooms than in plywood boxes

B. Whether people who apply anti-termite pesticides typically wear protective equipment that prevents them from being exposed to the pesticide

C. Whether people whose house is being treated with anti-termite pesticide generally know they should remain out of their house during the hours immediately after the pesticide's application

D. Whether there are anti-termite pesticides toxic to humans that, when subjected to the manufacturers' test

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D. Whether there are anti-termite pesticides toxic to humans that, when subjected to the manufacturers' test, dissipate completely from the air in the boxes in well under eight hours

E. Whether anti-termite pesticides that are not toxic to humans tend to take longer to dissipate than those that are toxic

•

Which of the following most logically completes the argument?

In a typical year, Innovair's airplanes are involved in 35 collisions while parked or being towed in airports, with a resulting yearly cost of $1,000,000 for repairs.

To reduce the frequency of ground collisions, Innovair will begin giving its ground crews additional training, at an annual cost of $500,000. Although this will cut the number of ground collisions by about half at best, the drop in repair costs can be expected to be much greater, since _____.

A. most ground collisions happen when ground crews are rushing to minimize the time a delayed airplane spends on the ground

B. a ground collision typically occurs when there are no passengers on the airplane

C. the additional training will focus on helping ground crews avoid those kinds of ground collisions that cause the most costly damage

D. the $500,000 cost figure for the additional training of ground crews includes the wages that those crews will earn during the time spent in actual training

E. most ground collisions have been caused by the least experienced ground-crew members

•

Many agriculturally intensive areas of the world are beginning to encounter water scarcity problems. As a result, many farmers in these areas are likely to reduce their output as the water supply they need in order to maintain production shrinks. However, one group of farmers in such a region plans to increase their production by implementing techniques for water conservation.

Which of the following, if true, would most strongly support the prediction that the group's plan will succeed?

A. Farmers that can gain a larger share of the food market in their regions will be better positioned to control more water resources.

B. Most agricultural practices in areas with water shortages are water-intensive.

C. Other regions of the world not facing water shortages are likely to make up for the reduction in agricultural output.

D. Demand for agricultural products in the group's region is not expected to decline.

E. More than half the water used for agriculture in the farmers' region is lost to evaporation or leakage from irrigation channels.

•

Scientists propose placing seismic stations on the floor of the Pacific Ocean to warn threatened coastal communities on the northwestern coast of the United States of approaching tidal waves caused by earthquakes. Since forewarned communities could take steps to evacuate, many of the injuries and deaths that would otherwise occur could be avoided if the government would implement this proposal.

The answer to which of the following questions would be most important in determining whether implementing the proposal would be likely to achieve the desired result?

A. When was the last time that the coastal communities were threatened by an approaching tidal wave?

B. How far below sea level would the stations be located?

C. Would there be enough time after receiving warning of an approaching tidal wave for communities to evacuate safely?

D. How soon after a tidal wave hits land is it safe for evacuees to return to their communities?

E. Can the stations be equipped to collect and relay information about phenomena other than tidal waves caused by earthquakes?

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earthquakes?

•

Because the cork stoppers in wine bottles can leak, crumble, or become moldy, winemakers must often discard a significant proportion of their inventory of bottled wine. Bottlemaster, Inc., produces a plastic stopper that cannot leak, crumble, or mold. **Bottlemaster's plastic stopper is available to winemakers for a price only slightly higher than that of traditional cork stoppers**, and cork prices are expected to rise considerably in the near future. Therefore, **Bottlemaster's plastic stopper will increase its share of the market for wine-bottle stoppers**.

In the argument given, the two portions in **boldface** play which of the following roles?

A. The first and the second each provide evidence to support the conclusion of the argument.

B. The first presents information that, in light of other information presented, provides evidence to support the conclusion of the argument; the second is that conclusion.

C. The first is evidence that has been used to support a position the argument opposes; the second is the conclusion of the argument.

D. The first is evidence that has been used to support a position that the argument opposes; the second provides evidence to support the conclusion of the argument.

E. The first is a claim the argument challenges; the second is a conclusion on which that challenge is based.

•

Only a reduction of 10 percent in the number of scheduled flights using Greentown's airport will allow the delays that are so common there to be avoided. Hevelia airstrip, 40 miles away, would, if upgraded and expanded, be an attractive alternative for fully 20 percent of the passengers using Greentown airport. Nevertheless, experts reject the claim that turning Hevelia into a full-service airport would end the chronic delays at Greentown.

Which of the following, if true, most helps to justify the experts' position?

A. Turning Hevelia into a full-service airport would require not only substantial construction at the airport itself but also the construction of new access highways.

B. A second largely undeveloped airstrip close to Greentown airport would be a more attractive alternative than Hevelia for many passengers who now use Greentown.

C. Hevelia airstrip lies in a relatively undeveloped area but would, if it became a full-service airport, be a magnet for commercial and residential development.

D. If an airplane has to wait to land, the extra jet fuel required adds significantly to the airline's costs.

E. Several airlines use Greentown as a regional hub, so that most flights landing at Greentown have many passengers who then take different flights to reach their final destinations.

•

Farmer: Worldwide, just three grain crops—rice, wheat, and corn—account for most human caloric intake. To maintain this level of caloric intake and also keep pace with global population growth, yields per acre from each of these crops will have to increase at least 1.5 percent every year, given that the supply of cultivated land is diminishing. Therefore, the government should increase funding for research into new ways to improve yields.

Which of the following is an assumption on which the farmer's argument depends?

A. It is solely the government's responsibility to ensure that the amount of rice, wheat, and corn produced worldwide keeps pace with global population growth.

B. Increasing government funding for research into new ways to improve the yields per acre of rice, wheat, and corn crops would help to increase total worldwide annual production of food from these crops.

C. Increasing the yields per acre of rice, wheat, and corn is more important than increasing the yields per acre of other crops.

D. Current levels of funding for research into ways of improving grain crop yields per acre have enabled grain crop yields per acre to increase by more than 1.5 percent per year worldwide.

E. In coming decades, rice, wheat, and corn will become a minor part of human caloric intake, unless there is government-funded research to increase their yields per acre.

•

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The air quality board recently informed Coffee Roast, a small coffee roasting firm, of a complaint regarding the smoke from its roaster. Recently enacted air quality regulations require machines roasting more than 10 pounds of coffee to be equipped with expensive smoke-dissipating afterburners. The firm, however, roasts only 8 pounds of coffee at a time. Nevertheless, the company has decided to purchase and install an afterburner.

Which of the following, if true, most strongly supports the firm's decision?

A. Until settling on the new air quality regulations, the board had debated whether to require afterburners for machines roasting more than 5 pounds of coffee at a time.

B. Coffee roasted in a machine equipped with an afterburner has its flavor subtly altered.

C. The cost to the firm of an afterburner is less than the cost of replacing its roaster with a smaller one.

D. Fewer complaints are reported in areas that maintain strict rules regarding afterburners.

E. The firm has reason to fear that negative publicity regarding the complaints could result in lost sales.

•

People who do regular volunteer work tend to live longer, on average, than people who do not. It has been found that "doing good," a category that certainly includes volunteer work, releases endorphins, the brain's natural opiates, which induce in people a feeling of well-being. Clearly, there is a connection: regular releases of endorphins must in some way help to extend people's lives.

Which of the following, if true, most seriously undermines the force of the evidence given as support for the hypothesis that endorphins promote longevity?

A. People who do regular volunteer work are only somewhat more likely than others to characterize the work they do for a living as "doing good."

B. Although extremely high levels of endorphins could be harmful to health, such levels are never reached as a result of the natural release of endorphins.

C. There are many people who have done some volunteer work but who do not do such work regularly.

D. People tend not to become involved in regular volunteer work unless they are healthy and energetic to begin with.

E. Releases of endorphins are responsible for the sense of well-being experienced by many long-distance runners while running.

•

A study compared a sample of Swedish people older than 75 who needed in-home assistance with a similar sample of Israeli people. The people in the two samples received both informal assistance, provided by family and friends, and formal assistance, professionally provided. Although Sweden and Israel have equally well-funded and comprehensive systems for providing formal assistance, the study found that the people in the Swedish sample received more formal assistance, on average, than those in the Israeli sample.

Which of the following, if true, does most to explain the difference that the study found?

A. A companion study found that among children needing special in-home care, the amount of formal assistance they received was roughly the same in Sweden as in Israel.

B. More Swedish than Israeli people older than 75 live in rural areas where formal assistance services are sparse or nonexistent.

C. Although in both Sweden and Israel much of the funding for formal assistance ultimately comes from the central government, the local structures through which assistance is delivered are different in the two countries.

D. In recent decades, the increase in life expectancy of someone who is 75 years old has been greater in Israel than in Sweden.

E. In Israel, people older than 75 tend to live with their children, whereas in Sweden people of that age tend to live alone.

•

Film director: It is true that certain characters and plot twists in my newly released film *The Big Heist* are similar to characters and plot twists in *Thieves*, a movie that came out last year. Pointing to these similarities, the film studio

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that produced *Thieves* is now accusing me of taking ideas from that film. The accusation is clearly without merit. All production work on *The Big Heist* was actually completed months before *Thieves* was released.

Which of the following, if true, provides the strongest support for the director's position?

A. Before *Thieves* began production, its script had been circulating for several years among various film studios, including the studio that produced *The Big Heist*.

B. The characters and plot twists that are most similar in the two films have close parallels in many earlier films of the same genre.

C. The film studio that produced *Thieves* seldom produces films in this genre.

D. The director of *Thieves* worked with the director of *The Big Heist* on several earlier projects.

E. Production work on *Thieves* began before production work on *The Big Heist* was started.

•

In Mernia, commercial fossil hunters often sell important fossils they have found, not to universities or museums but to individual collectors, who pay much better but generally do not allow researchers access to their collections. To increase the number of fossils available for research, some legislators propose requiring all fossils that are found in Mernia to be sold only to universities or museums.

Which of the following, if true, most strongly indicates that the legislators' proposal will fail to achieve its goal?

A. Some fossil hunters in Mernia are not commercial fossil hunters, but rather are amateurs who keep the fossils that they find.

B. Most fossils found in Mernia are common types that have little scientific interest.

C. Commercial fossil hunters in Mernia currently sell some of the fossils they find to universities and museums.

D. Many universities in Mernia do not engage in fossil research.

E. Most fossils are found by commercial fossil hunters, and they would give up looking for fossils if they were no longer allowed to sell to individual collectors.

•

Economist: Tropicorp, which constantly seeks profitable investment opportunities, has been buying and clearing sections of tropical forest for cattle ranching, although pastures newly created there become useless for grazing after just a few years. The company has not gone into rubber tapping, even though greater profits can be made from rubber tapping, which leaves the forest intact. Thus, some environmentalists argue that **Tropicorp's actions do not serve even its own economic interest.** However, the initial investment required for a successful rubber-tapping operation is larger than that needed for a cattle ranch; there is a shortage of workers employable in rubber-tapping operations; and taxes are higher on profits from rubber tapping than on profits from cattle ranching. Consequently, **the environmentalists' conclusion is probably wrong.**

In the economist's argument, the two **boldfaced** portions play which of the following roles?

A. The first supports the conclusion of the economist's argument; the second calls that conclusion into question.

B. The first states the conclusion of the economist's argument; the second supports that conclusion.

C. The first supports the conclusion of the environmentalists' argument; the second states that conclusion.

D. The first states the conclusion of the environmentalists' argument; the second states the conclusion of the economist's argument.

E. Each supports the conclusion of the economist's argument.

•

Brown tides are growths of algae on the sea's surface that prevent sunlight from reaching marine plants below, thereby destroying not only the plants but also the shellfish that live off these plants. Biologists recently isolated a virus that, when added to seawater, kills the algae that cause brown tides. Adding large quantities of this virus to waters affected by brown tides will therefore make it possible to save the populations of shellfish that inhabit those waters.

Which of the following, if true, provides the most support for the conclusion of the argument?

A. When applied in large quantities, the virus not only kills the algae that cause brown tides but also many harmless

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A. When applied in large quantities, the virus not only kills the algae that cause brown tides but also many harmless kinds of algae.

B. Marine animals that prey on shellfish avoid areas of the sea in which brown tides are occurring.

C. The number of different kinds of viruses present in seawater is far greater than many marine biologists had, until recently, believed.

D. The presence of large quantities of the virus in seawater does not adversely affect the growth of marine plants.

E. The amount of the virus naturally present in seawater in which brown tides occur is neither significantly greater nor significantly less than the amount present in seawater in which brown tides do not occur.

•

In persons with astigmatism, the clear outer layer of the eye is deformed in a way that impairs and sometimes distorts vision. The elongated figures in the paintings of El Greco (1541–1614) were so unusual that some critics sought to explain them by hypothesizing that, without knowing it, El Greco had an astigmatism that caused everything to appear to him in the distorted way that was characteristic of his painted figures.

The proposed explanation is most vulnerable to the criticism that it fails to

A. establish that during the period in which El Greco lived, there was any correction available to those who did realize their vision was distorted

B. provide evidence that astigmatism was common in the 1500s and 1600s

C. consider that the critics who proposed the explanation might have suffered from astigmatism

D. consider the effect of the hypothesized astigmatism on El Greco's perception of his own paintings

E. allow for the possibility that artists see the world differently than do nonartists

•

Marketing executive for Magu Corporation: Whenever Magu opens a manufacturing facility in a new city, the company should sponsor, or make donations to, a number of nonprofit organizations in that city. Doing so would improve Magu's image in the community, and thus the money spent on such charitable ventures would lead to increased sales.

Which statement would, if true, point to the most serious weakness in the marketing executive's advice?

A. Magu sells its products internationally, so sales in any one city represent only a small portion of total revenue.

B. Spending on charitable ventures would require Magu to decrease direct advertisements, which are the most effective means of reaching its target customers.

C. If market conditions change, Magu may have to close any such facility or relocate it.

D. Some nonprofit organizations are poorly organized, so money donated to them would be of little benefit to the community.

E. If workers at the manufacturing facility believed their wages or working conditions were poor, their complaints would outweigh any good impressions generated by Magu's donations or sponsorships.

•

In the last few years, plant scientists have been able to genetically engineer seeds to produce crops highly resistant to insect damage. Farmers growing crops with these seeds will be able to spend significantly less on pesticides. This cost reduction would more than make up for the higher cost of the genetically engineered seeds. Clearly, therefore, farmers who grow crops from genetically engineered seeds will be able to reduce their costs by using them.

Which of the following, if true, most weakens the argument?

A. Plant scientists have not yet developed insect-resistant strains of every crop that is currently grown commercially.

B. The cost of several commonly used pesticides is expected to rise in the next few years.

C. Crops grown from the genetically engineered seeds require significantly more fertilizer and water to grow well than do crops grown from nonengineered seeds.

D. In the future, the cost of genetically engineered seeds is likely to fall to the level of nonengineered seeds.

E. The crops that now require the greatest expenditure on pesticides are not the ones for which genetically

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E. The crops that now require the greatest expenditure on pesticides are not the ones for which genetically engineered seeds will become available.

•

Educational theorist: Recent editorials have called for limits on the amount of homework assigned to schoolchildren younger than 12. They point out that free-time activities play an important role in childhood development and that homework in large quantities can severely restrict children's free time, hindering their development. But the actual average homework time for children under 12—little more than 30 minutes per night—leaves plenty of free time. In reality, therefore, the editorials' rationale cannot justify the restriction they advocate.

Which of the following, if true, would most seriously call into question the educational theorist's conclusion?

A. Some teachers give as homework assignments work of a kind that research suggests is most effective educationally when done in class.

B. For children younger than 12, regularly doing homework in the first years of school has no proven academic value, but many educators believe that it fosters self-discipline and time management.

C. Some homework assignments are related to free-time activities that children engage in, such as reading or hobbies.

D. A substantial proportion of schoolchildren under 12, particularly those in their first few years of school, have less than 10 minutes of homework assigned per night.

E. Some free-time activities teach children skills or information that they later find useful in their schoolwork.

•

Thyrian lawmaker: Thyria's Cheese Importation Board inspects all cheese shipments to Thyria and rejects shipments not meeting specified standards. Yet only 1 percent is ever rejected. Therefore, since the health consequences and associated economic costs of not rejecting that 1 percent are negligible, whereas the board's operating costs are considerable, for economic reasons alone the board should be disbanded.

Consultant: I disagree. The threat of having their shipments rejected deters many cheese exporters from shipping substandard product.

The consultant responds to the lawmaker's argument by

A. rejecting the lawmaker's argument while proposing that the standards according to which the board inspects imported cheese should be raised

B. providing evidence that the lawmaker's argument has significantly overestimated the cost of maintaining the board

C. objecting to the lawmaker's introducing into the discussion factors that are not strictly economic

D. pointing out a benefit of maintaining the board which the lawmaker's argument has failed to consider

E. shifting the discussion from the argument at hand to an attack on the integrity of the cheese inspectors

•

The tulu, a popular ornamental plant, does not reproduce naturally and is only bred and sold by specialized horticultural companies. Unfortunately, the tulu is easily devastated by a contagious fungal rot. The government ministry plans to reassure worried gardeners by requiring all tulu plants to be tested for fungal rot before being sold. However, infected plants less than 30 weeks old have generally not built up enough fungal rot in their systems to be detected reliably. And many tulu plants are sold before they are 24 weeks old.

Which of the following, if performed by the government ministry, could logically be expected to overcome the problem with their plan to test for the fungal rot?

A. Releasing a general announcement that tulu plants less than 30 weeks old cannot be effectively tested for fungal rot

B. Requiring all tulu plants less than 30 weeks old to be labeled as such

C. Researching possible ways to test tulu plants less than 24 weeks old for fungal rot

D. Ensuring that tulu plants are not sold before they are 30 weeks old

E. Quarantining all tulu plants from horticultural companies at which any case of fungal rot has been detected until those tulu plants can be tested for fungal rot

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those tuna plants can be tested for fungal rot

•

While many people think of genetic manipulation of food crops as being aimed at developing larger and larger plant varieties, some plant breeders have in fact concentrated on discovering or producing dwarf varieties, which are roughly half as tall as normal varieties.

Which of the following would, if true, most help to explain the strategy of the plant breeders referred to above?

A. Plant varieties used as food by some are used as ornamentals by others.

B. The wholesale prices of a given crop decrease as the supply of it increases.

C. Crops once produced exclusively for human consumption are often now used for animal feed.

D. Short plants are less vulnerable to strong wind and heavy rains.

E. Nations with large industrial sectors tend to consume more processed grains.

•

Secret passwords are often used to control access to computers.

When employees select their own passwords, they frequently choose such easily guessed passwords as their initials or birth dates. To improve security, employers should assign randomly generated passwords to employees rather than allowing employees to make up their own.

Which of the following, if true, most seriously undermines the conclusion drawn above?

A. If passwords are generated randomly, it is theoretically possible that employees will be assigned passwords that they might have selected on their own.

B. Randomly generated passwords are so difficult for employees to recall that they often record the passwords in places where the passwords could be easily seen by others.

C. Computer systems protected by passwords are designed to ignore commands that are entered by employees or others who use invalid passwords.

D. In general, the higher the level of security maintained at the computer system, the more difficult it is for unauthorized users to obtain access to the system.

E. Control of physical access to computers by the use of locked doors and guards should be used in addition to passwords in order to maintain security.

•

The economy around Lake Paqua depends on fishing of the lake's landlocked salmon population. In recent years, scarcity of food for salmon there has caused a decline in both the number and the size of the adult salmon in the lake. As a result, the region's revenues from salmon fishing have declined significantly. To remedy this situation, officials plan to introduce shrimp, which can serve as a food source for adult salmon, into Lake Paqua.

Which of the following, if true, most seriously calls into question the plan's chances for success?

A. Salmon is not a popular food among residents of the Lake Paqua region.

B. Tourists coming to fish for sport generate more income for residents of the Lake Paqua region than does commercial fishing.

C. The shrimp to be introduced into Lake Paqua are of a variety that is too small to be harvested for human consumption.

D. The primary food for both shrimp and juvenile salmon is plankton, which is not abundant in Lake Paqua.

E. Fishing regulations prohibit people from keeping any salmon they have caught in Lake Paqua that are smaller than a certain minimum size.

Questions 673–738 — Difficulty: Medium

673. Airline representative: The percentage of flight delays caused by airline error decreased significantly this year. This indicates that airlines listened to complaints about preventable errors and addressed the problems. Although delays caused by weather and other uncontrollable factors will always be part of travel, preventable delays are clearly decreasing.

Which of the following most clearly points to a logical flaw in the representative's reasoning?

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Which of the following most clearly points to a logical flaw in the representative's reasoning?

A. Airlines may be motivated by financial concerns to underreport the percentage of flight delays caused by airline error.

B. The delays caused by uncontrollable factors could have led to an increase in complaints to airlines.

C. Complaints may not be the most reliable measure of how many errors occurred in a given year.

D. Delays caused by weather and other uncontrollable factors could have increased dramatically during the year under discussion.

E. Airline customers might not believe that particular delays were caused by uncontrollable factors rather than airline error.

674. Although the school would receive financial benefits if it had soft drink vending machines in the cafeteria, we should not allow them. Allowing soft drink machines there would not be in our students' interest. If our students start drinking more soft drinks, they will be less healthy.

The argument depends on which of the following?

A. If the soft drink vending machines were placed in the cafeteria, students would consume more soft drinks as a result.

B. The amount of soft drinks that most students at the school currently drink is not detrimental to their health.

C. Students are apt to be healthier if they do not drink soft drinks at all than if they just drink small amounts occasionally.

D. Students will not simply bring soft drinks from home if the soft drink vending machines are not placed in the cafeteria.

E. The school's primary concern should be to promote good health among its students.

675. Many athletes inhale pure oxygen after exercise in an attempt to increase muscular reabsorption of oxygen. Measured continuously after exercise, however, the blood lactate levels of athletes who inhale pure oxygen are practically identical, on average, to those of athletes who breathe normal air. The lower the blood lactate level is, the higher the muscular reabsorption of oxygen is.

If the statements above are all true, they most strongly support which of the following conclusions?

A. Athletes' muscular reabsorption of oxygen is not increased when they inhale pure oxygen instead of normal air.

B. High blood lactate levels cannot be reduced.

C. Blood lactate levels are a poor measure of oxygen reabsorption by muscles.

D. The amount of oxygen reabsorbed by an athlete's muscles always remains constant.

E. The inhaling of pure oxygen has no legitimate role in athletics.

676. Historian: Fifteenth-century advances in mapmaking contributed to the rise of modern nation-states. In medieval Europe (from the fifth to the fifteenth century), sovereignty centered in cities and towns and radiated outward, with boundaries often ambiguously defined. The conceptual shift toward the modern state began in the late fifteenth century, when mapmakers learned to reflect geography accurately by basing maps on latitude-longitude grids. By the mid-seventeenth century, nearly all maps showed boundary lines.

Which of the following would, if true, most strengthen the historian's reasoning?

A. Borders did not become codified in Europe until certain treaties were signed in the early nineteenth century.

B. During the medieval period, various authorities in Europe claimed power over collections of cities and towns, not contiguous territories.

C. Many members of the political elite collected maps as a hobby during the late sixteenth and early seventeenth centuries.

D. Seventeenth-century treatises and other sources of political authority describe areas of sovereignty rather than illustrate them using maps.

E. During the fifteenth century in Europe, mapmakers simplified the borders of sovereignty by drawing clear lines of demarcation between political powers.

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677. Sascha: The attempt to ban parliament's right to pass directed-spending bills—bills that contain provisions specifically funding the favorite projects of some powerful politicians—is antidemocratic. Our nation's constitution requires that money be drawn from our treasury only when so stipulated by laws passed by parliament, the branch of government most directly representative of the citizens. This requirement is based on the belief that exercising the power to spend public resources involves the ultimate exercise of state authority and that therefore _____.

Which of the following most logically completes Sascha's argument?

A. designating funding specifically for the favorite projects of some powerful politicians should be considered antidemocratic

B. the right to exercise such a power should belong exclusively to the branch of government most directly representative of the citizens

C. exercising the power to spend public resources is in most cases—but not all—protected by the constitution

D. modifications to any spending bills should be considered expenditures authorized by law

E. only officials who are motivated by concerns for reelection should retain that power

678. Boreal owls range over a much larger area than do other owls of similar size. Scientists have hypothesized that **it is scarcity of prey that leads the owls to range so widely.** This hypothesis would be hard to confirm directly, since it is not possible to produce a sufficiently accurate count of the populations of small mammals inhabiting the forests where boreal owls live. Careful study of owl behavior has, however, shown that **boreal owls do range over larger areas when they live in regions where food of the sort eaten by small mammals is comparatively sparse.** This indicates that the scientists' hypothesis is not sheer speculation.

In the argument given, the two **boldfaced** portions play which of the following roles?

A. The first presents an explanatory hypothesis; the second states the main conclusion of the argument.

B. The first presents an explanatory hypothesis; the second presents evidence tending to support this hypothesis.

C. The first presents an explanatory hypothesis; the second presents evidence to support an alternative explanation.

D. The first describes a position that the argument opposes; the second presents evidence to undermine the support for the position being opposed.

E. The first describes a position that the argument opposes; the second states the main conclusion of the argument.

679. Cognitive scientist: Using the pioneering work of comparative psychologist Gordon Gallup as a model, several studies have investigated animals' capacity for mirror self-recognition (MSR). Most animals exposed to a mirror respond only with social behavior, such as aggression. However, in the case of the great apes, repeated exposure to mirrors leads to self-directed behaviors, such as exploring the inside of the mouth, suggesting that these animals recognize the reflection as an image of self. The implication of these studies is that the great apes have a capacity for self-awareness unique among nonhuman species.

The cognitive scientist makes which of the following assumptions in the argument above?

A. Gallup's work has established that the great apes have a capacity for MSR unique among nonhuman species.

B. If an animal does not have the capacity for MSR, it does not have the capacity for self-awareness.

C. If a researcher exposes an animal to a mirror and that animal exhibits social behavior, that animal is incapable of being self-aware.

D. When exposed to a mirror, all animals display either social behavior or self-directed behavior.

E. Animals that do not exhibit MSR may demonstrate a capacity for self-awareness in other ways.

680.

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